Evie Thompson

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Labour Economics, Family Economics

EDUCATION

London School of Economics
MRes/PhD in Economics — 2021 – 2027 (expected)
Advisors: Matthias Doepke, Guy Michaels

University of St Andrews
MSc in Economics, Distinction — 2019 – 2020

University of London
Graduate Diploma in Economics, Distinction — 2018 – 2019

King's College London
BA in Philosophy, First-Class Honours — 2014 – 2017
Year abroad, University of California, Berkeley (GPA 3.925/4.0), 2015 – 2016

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Money, Time, and the Demand for Children", with Guy Michaels (LSE)
AEA RCT Registry AEARCTR-0019209

US fertility has fallen well below replacement, even as stated fertility ideals have not. We ask how much money and time women are willing to trade off for additional children, a question that is difficult to answer using observational data or even natural experiments. We field a discrete choice experiment in which 1,995 women choose between hypothetical futures varying the number of additional children, household income, and time use. Demand falls with both income and time prices, and rises with income faster than proportionally: larger families are a luxury good. Exploratory results show that full-time work, but not part-time work, is perceived as costly, and that baseline demand varies by age, religiosity, and desired fertility even as price responses vary less. Notably, women on average require compensation, often significant, to accept a second additional child, including many who say they want two more. This finding complicates the standard reading of a stated ideal of two children as evidence of unmet demand: once its price is held fixed, we find little demand to reach it.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Why Do Couples Disagree about Having Children?"

In low-fertility countries, couples often disagree about having another child, and women are more often the ones who do not want one. Leading theories attribute this partly to the greater care and career costs women expect to bear; across high-income countries, fertility is higher where men do a larger share of domestic work. Yet mothers still do most of the care, despite most men saying they prefer equal household arrangements. Understanding why couples disagree about having another child requires measuring each partner's preferences over the division of care, paid work and income, and how closely their preferences align. This paper fields a choice experiment with couples in which each partner separately chooses between hypothetical futures that randomise the number of additional children, total household income, each partner's share of that income, and both partners' paid work and care hours. I estimate how much income and time each partner would give up for another child, and how this depends on the division of care, paid work and earnings. Using both partners' choices, I quantify disagreement about having another child under couples' current arrangements and predict how it would change under alternative ones.

"Replication as a Form of Deterrence"

The use of replication in science is crucial for checking the validity of research methods and results. This paper demonstrates another use of replication, as a form of deterrence against low-quality research. I propose a principal-agent model of a journal that publishes a researcher's paper. The journal induces research effort by publishing replications of the researcher's work, introducing a risk that the researcher is caught if they perform bad quality research. If caught, the researcher incurs a reputational cost. When this cost is high, the journal's strategy is more effective and they are able to induce higher effort levels. I also find that the optimal strategy for the journal is to only publish replications that overturn the results of the original study. Finally, when the researcher knows before submitting that their work is poor quality, I characterise the conditions under which the journal chooses to publish enough replications to deter them from submitting.

PRESENTATIONS

2026: London Family Economics Workshop; LSE Economics Job Market Seminar; LSE Labour Economics Student Conference; LSE Labour Economics Work in Progress Seminar

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Westminster City Council

Research Intern — March – May 2024

Report on skills gaps in Westminster: census data analysis using the O*NET skills database

Global Priorities Institute, University of Oxford

Predoctoral Fellow in Economics — 2021

TEACHING

London School of Economics, Class Teacher

Microeconomics I (EC1A1), undergraduate	2023/24
Contracts and Organisations (EC476), postgraduate	2023/24
Intermediate Microeconomics (EC201), LSE Summer School	2023
Microeconomics II (EC2A3), undergraduate	2022/23

SERVICE

Academic Mentor, London School of Economics — 2025 – 2026

AWARDS AND FUNDING

ESRC Doctoral Studentship	2021 – 2026
Economics Teaching Bonus Award, Department of Economics, LSE	2024
Economics Teaching Bonus Award, Department of Economics, LSE	2023

SKILLS AND PERSONAL

Software: Stata, R, Qualtrics, LaTeX

Citizenship: British

REFERENCES

Matthias Doepke
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Guy Michaels
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Tim Besley
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